

Beta version of VLC player in Google Play on your platter

The VLC mobile team has finally released the beta version of the VLC player on Google Play Store. It was a much-awaited release, but the not-so-good news is that it's not meant for all of us. The VLC team says that the beta version of the app, dubbed as Neon, is available only for devices powered by ARMv7 processors. However, the team has assured that other devices will be supported by other applications.

VLC is a free and open source multimedia player, and is capable of opening just any media file. One added advantage is that it offers an audio-video media library, which has full search capabilities. It also offers support for network streams, subtitles and HLS. Since it is the beta version, the developers have clarified that it is unstable and slow, and also needs performance improvements and UI facelift. Also, it will work with only a limited set of hardware.

Some of the features that it brings include: playing of video and audio files like in the desktop version of VLC, widget for audio control and support for audio headsets.



Cricket live scores on your desktop in a jiffy

Cricket lovers are sure in for a treat! GillyCricket is an open source application, which provides the scores of each match live. The scores of a live match reach your screen within a fraction of a second.

Prasanna Venkadesh, the maker of the app, informed, "By using this app in your desktop, you can get the live score in maximum 6-7 seconds and minimum of 4 seconds, even if you have a slow Internet connection! Obviously, the time consumed will be less in a fast Internet connection." They say necessity is the mother of invention. It was Venkadesh's necessity that inspired him to design an app like this. He said, "I was in a place where I did not have fast Internet connection and television. All I had was a slow USB wireless Internet connection. I wanted to keep myself updated with the scores in IPL 2012. But the slow Internet connection was a major hindrance. So, I thought of making an app that fetches scores really fast."

An Android healthcare smartphone for you

LifeWatch V is the latest offering from LifeWatch Technologies, Israel, which can help you check your body temperature, blood glucose and perform a 25-second ECG. The company touts it as the first healthcare smartphone.

LifeWatch Technologies has paid a lot of attention to the hardware of the device, apart from the software. It has used specific sensors for the purpose of medical testing. It also stores the health data of individuals on the cloud so that a comparison with medical history is possible, whenever required. Users can also share the data with any external source via an e-mail or a message.

The smartphone has some integrated apps for setting the medication reminders, planning a diet and monitoring exercise logs. LifeWatch has also provided call-centre support, which offers users expert medical help whenever they ask for it. These services, including diet and exercise planning, are offered at a premium.

Ubuntu TV likely to hit Indian shores next year

Broadening the horizons of its open source operating system beyond the PC domain, Canonical recently ventured into the television division with Ubuntu TV. The company had unveiled the first Ubuntu TV at CES in Las Vegas this year. Ubuntu TV is likely to reach users around early next year. The device will be launched in India around the same time, said Jane Silber, chief executive officer, Canonical.



Silber said, "Ubuntu TV is about using the same Ubuntu core and underlying platform (and similar Unity-based but not identical user experience) and bringing the same Ubuntu principles that we bring to the desktop to the TV. So the simplicity and the dynamics remain the same, which we think is needed in a smart TV. TVs are becoming computers these days. People now have computing power in their smart displays. I think we will see the same convergence that is happening in phones and desktops in the TVs too. People now download an operating system for their computers but, in future, they will do that for their TVs. We hope to see Ubuntu TVs shipping early next year. Ubuntu TVs should possibly ship in India around the same time as in other global markets."